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22 OCTOBER 1954
SUPERSEDING
MIL-C-1312A
17 MAY 1950

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CARTRIDGES, BLANK, SMALL ARMS

This specification has been approved by the Department of Defense for use of the Departments of the Army, the Navy and the Air Force.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope.—This specification covers blank cartridges intended for saluting and training purposes.

1.2 Classification.—One type each of the following cartridges is covered by this specification.

Cartridge, Blank, Caliber .30, M1909
Cartridge, Blank, Caliber .30, M1909 Alternate.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS, STANDARDS, DRAWINGS AND PUBLICATIONS.

2.1 The following specifications, standards, drawings and publications of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification.

SPECIFICATIONS

MILITARY

MIL-A-625 — Ammunition, Small Arms, General Specification for.

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 — Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

MIL-STD-129 —Marking of Shipments.

DRAWINGS

ORDNANCE CORPS

27-79-27 — Cartridge, Blank, Caliber .30, M1909, List of Drawings, Specifications and Inspection for Acceptance.

27-79-27A — Cartridge, Blank, Caliber .30, M1909 Alternate, List of Drawings, Specifications and Inspection for Acceptance.

42-42-4 — Rifle, U. S., Caliber .30, M1903A3.

42-24-2 — Rifle, U. S., Caliber .30, M1.

D7142391 — Gun, Machine, Browning, Caliber .30, M1917A1.

C5509889 — Attachment, Blank firing, M3A1.

D7142392 or D7142393 — Gun, machine, Browning, Caliber .30, M1919A4.

C5545973 —Attachment, Blank firing, M6.

PUBLICATIONS

ORDNANCE CORPS

ORD-M608-PM, Volume III — Manual of Test Methods for Small Arms Ammunition.

ORD-SIP-S315— Visual Inspection Standards for Small Arms Ammunition.

311573—54—(186)

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ORD–SIP–S324— Standard Inspection Procedures for Packing of Small Arms Ammunition.

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring agency or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Design and construction.

3.1.1 *General.*—General requirements shall conform to Specification MIL–A–625 except as modified by this specification.

3.1.2 *Material.*—Material shall conform to material requirements of Specification MIL–A–625 except as modified by this specification.

3.1.2.1 *Case.*—Use of cases, second class (including cases from the pull down of Grade 3 ammunition), or fired and reworked or both, if free from defects which may interfere with proper functioning or which are classified as visual defectives, shall be permitted.

3.1.3 *Physical.* — Physical requirements shall conform to Specification MIL–A–625 except as modified by this specification and drawings. The defects shall be classified in accordance with Table I. The acceptable quality level of the ammunition with respect to visual and dimensional defects shall be as follows:

Defect	*Percent*
Critical	0
Major	.65
Minor	1.5

TABLE I. *Defect Classifications*

Cal. .30	Defect	Critical	Major	Minor
	Visual			
2	Corroded or Stained, if etched			x
3	Mixed ammunition types			
	a. Dummy, Grenade			x
	b. All others not included in a.	x		
	Split case between head and rear face of wad[1]		x	
	Split case between mouth and rear face of wad			x
7	Perforated case[1]		x	
12	Scaly metal			x
14	Fold			x
19	Defective head			x
	Joint between case neck and wad not covered by lacquer			x
	Joint between case neck and wad covered by lacquer but wad not completely covered by lacquer.			x
	Opening between wad and case wall[1]		x	
32	No primer		x	
33	Cocked primer		x	
34	Inverted primer		x	
35	Loose primer		x	
	Gaging			
	Failure to chamber in M1 Rifle[2]		x	
	High primer		x	

[1] Counted as "minor" if no powder can be shaken from the case.

[2] Rifle shall be adjusted to minimum head space and bolt shall be allowed to close by spring pressure. Preliminary gaging may be done in the maximum profile and alinement gage for information only.

Note. Refer to publication ORD–SIP–S315 for definite classification of numbered defects.

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3.2 Screen perforation for cartridges, blank, caliber .30.—Perforation of the screen by the wads of more than 1.2 percent of the cartridges fired shall not be permitted.

3.3 Function and casualty.—Function and casualty firing defects plus firing defects discovered in other tests shall not exceed the percentage shown in Table II.

3.3.1 *Cyclic rate.*—The cyclic rate of machine guns shall be not less than the following: Caliber .30—not less than 400 cartridges per minute.

3.3.1.1 If the ammunition fail to operate the gun at the minimum cyclic rate specified, and the failure has been found to be caused by the blank fire attachment, the attachment shall be replaced and the test repeated.

3.4 Workmanship. — Workmanship shall conform to Specification MIL–A–625.

TABLE II. *Defects and Limits permitted in a sample*

Defect	Percent
Primer:	
Escape of gas through primer cup	5.0
Loose primer[1]	0.2
Blown primer[2]	0.0
Case:	
Splits, neck, shoulder or mouth	5.0
Splits, body	0.8
Splits, through head	0.1
Complete rupture[3]	0.1
Partial rupture	0.2
Detached metal[3]	0.0
Gun stoppage[4]	2.5

[1] Primer falls out of pocket on retraction of bolt after firing. If the primer remains in the pocket but is visually loose, this shall be reported for information with no limit specified.

[2] Primer not in pocket after firing and both head of cartridge case and primer pocket enlarged and distorted.

[3] Any particle of metal which becomes separated from the case between the mouth and the juncture of the shoulder and neck shall be classified as detached metal. A complete rupture at this location on the case shall be classed as detached metal.

[4] Gun stoppages, including misfire, observed in all tests shall be included.

Note.—The number of defects permitted is calculated as specified in Specification MIL–A–625.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Sampling.

4.1.1 *Ammunition lot.*—Unless otherwise specified, the number of cartridges in an ammunition lot shall be the number produced in 1 day at the particular plant or unit concerned. However, where a day's production is relatively small, a lot may include the production of two or more consecutive days, but not more than 2,000,000 cartridges. The number of cartridges in a probational lot shall not exceed 500,000.

4.1.2 *Inspection lot.*—The contractor shall submit an ammunition lot for visual inspection and gaging by inspection lots.

4.1.3 *Selection.*—The acceptance samples of cartridges shall be selected in accordance with Standard MIL–STD–105. The quantity of cartridges in the acceptance sample for visual, inspection and gaging shall be as specified in Standard MIL–STD–105. The quantity for various acceptance tests other than inspection and gaging shall be as specified in Table III.

TABLE III. *Acceptance samples*

Test	Number of cartridges caliber .30
Screen perforation:	
Rifle, U.S., Caliber .30, M1903A3	200
Rifle, U.S., Caliber .30, M1	200
Function and casualty:	
Gun, machine, Browning, Caliber .30, M1917A1 with attachment, blank firing, M3A1; in burst of 100 cartridges.	400
Gun, machine, Browning, Caliber .30, M1919A4 with attachment, blank firing, M6; in burst of 100 cartridges each in each of 2 guns.	400

Note. Retest shall be made with double the number of cartridges specified in Table III.

4.2 Inspection.

4.2.1 *Place of inspection.*—The visual inspection, gaging and tests for acceptance

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shall be in accordance with Specification MIL–A–625 and unless otherwise specified by the procuring activity shall be made at the place of manufacture.

4.2.2 *Inspection procedure.*

4.2.2.1 *Contractor inspection.*—Contractor shall, by quality control sampling or by 100 percent inspection and gaging, be satisfied that the major and minor defective cartridges in presented ammunition do not exceed percentages permitted by the acceptable quality levels specified in 3.1.3. Contractor shall, however, inspect 100 percent for critical visual defect listed in Table I.

4.2.2.2 *Government acceptance inspections.* — The Government Inspector shall inspect each cartridge of the acceptance sample for all defects listed in Table I. Any defects not listed in Table I which indicate that the ammunition is hazardous or otherwise unsuited for the purpose intended shall be brought to the attention of the contracting officer. The contracting officer shall report the defects to the Chief of Ordnance along with comments of the contractor.

4.3 Tests.

4.3.1 *Screen perforation.*

4.3.1.1 *Cartridges, blank, caliber .30, M1909, Drawing 27–79–27 and M1909 alternate, Drawing 27–79–27A.*—Cartridges shall be fired in Rifle, U. S., caliber .30, M1903A3, Drawing 42–42–4 and in Rifle, U. S. Caliber .30, M1, Drawing 42–24–2 with headspace 1.940 to 1.946 inches, inclusive. The M1 rifle shall be charged and operated manually.

4.3.1.2 *Method.*—Tests shall be in accordance with Publication ORD–M608–PM, Volume III, subsection 7–21.

4.3.2 *Function and casualty.*

4.3.2.1 Caliber .30 cartridges shall be fired full automatic from gun, machine, Browning, caliber .30, M1917A1, Drawing D7142391 with blank fire attachment, Drawing C5509889, and from gun, machine, Browning, caliber .30, M1919A4, Drawing D7142392 or Drawing D7142393 with blank fire attachment, Drawing C5545973. See 6.1.

4.3.2.2 *Method.* — Testing shall be in accordance with publication ORD–M608–PM, Volume III, subsection 7–15. The weapons shall be at room temperature at beginning of test and cooled between bursts.

4.3.3 *Defective small arm.* — When any firing defect is found to have been caused by the small arm used, such firing defect shall not be counted against the ammunition but the small arm shall be corrected or replaced and the test repeated. This applies also in any retest of ammunition.

4.3.4 *Firing defects.* — Any defects not covered by this specification that are found by the Government Inspector during the acceptance tests shall be recorded on the acceptance report and brought to the attention of the contracting officer. The contracting officer shall report the defects to the Chief of Ordnance along with comments of the manufacturer when the defects indicate that the ammunition is unsuited for the purpose intended.

4.3.5 *Retests.*—Retests shall be made in accordance with Specification MIL–A–625.

5. PREPARATION AND DELIVERY

5.1 Packing. — The cartridges shall be packed in accordance with the applicable drawings.

5.2 Each lot of packed ammunition shall be inspected for acceptance in accordance with Publication ORD–SIP–S324.

5.3 Marking and labeling.—Packing boxes shall be marked and labeled in accordance with the applicable drawings and Standard MIL–STD–129.

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5.4 Acceptable quality levels.—The acceptable quality levels of the ammunition with respect to packing and marking defects of ammunition for delivery shall be in accordance with Specification MIL-A-625 and Standard MIL-STD-105.

5.5 Loading of Ammunition for shipment. — The loading of ammunition lots for delivery shall be under the supervision of the Government Inspector and in accordance with Specification MIL-A-625.

6. NOTES

6.1 Flames and sparks should be held to a minimum.

6.2 Ordering data. — Procurement Documents should specify the title, number and date of this specification.

Patent notice.—This specification, together with specifications and drawings pertaining to it and bearing a "NOTICE" of similar restrictions, is intended for use only in connection with procurement by the United States Government, and shall not be reproduced either wholly or in part except when authorized in connection with Government procurement, nor be used for any other purpose except when specifically authorized by the Chief of Ordnance.

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